

Build a small usable repertoire

Opening Decisions

THE IDEA

A repertoire is a set of positions you understand and can reach against common replies. Begin with a manageable first move as White and a response to both 1.e4 and 1.d4 as Black. Learn plans, tactical warnings, and typical structures alongside moves.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A player may choose 1.e4, then prepare an answer to ...e5, the Sicilian, the French, and the Caro-Kann. Each branch needs a workable starting plan, not an encyclopedia of sidelines.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What belongs on a one-page repertoire note?

ANSWER AND REASONING

A short legal move sequence, intended piece squares, a central pawn break, one tactical danger, and the position where memorization ends. Explain why each move is played.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Prefer a small repertoire you can explain to a large one you can only recite.